CSE0001: DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

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INTRODUCTION

This report documents my comprehensive journey as a Student Digital Ambassador during my first year of B.Tech (AI & ML). The goal of this project was to develop a professional online presence, master digital communication and promote cybersecurity awareness. Through five structured tasks, I have transitioned from a regular internet user to a responsible digital citizen equipped with the tools needed for a career in technology

By establishing verified profiles on platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn and Kaggle, I have created a digital footprint that will track my academic and technical progress over the next four years. Furthermore, this project allowed me to explore critical areas such as cybersecurity, where I researched prevalent threats like phishing and UPI fraud.

TASK-1

For this task, I created a digital literacy awareness infographic using Canva. The infographic is divided into four main sections: what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices and professional online presence.

In the first section, I explained digital literacy as the ability to use digital devices and problem solving.
In the second section, I included useful tools like Google Docs, GitHub, Canva and Google Drive, which are helpful for students in their academic work.
The third section focuses on safe internet practices such as using strong passwords, avoiding unknown links.
The fourth section highlights the importance of maintaining a professional online presence through platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub.

While creating this infographic, I found it interesting to organize information in a simple and visually clear way. One difficulty I faced was adjusting the layout so that all sections fit properly without making the design look crowded.

TASK-2

For this task, I set up profiles on GitHub, Kaggle and LinkedIn.

GitHub is a place where I can store my coding projects and show my work to the world.

Kaggle is a famous platform for data science and AI competitions, which will help me practice my machine learning skills.

LinkedIn is a professional social network that helps me connect with experts, professors and future employers.

Over the next four years, I have a clear plan for these tools. I will use GitHub to build a portfolio of my class projects and AI hackathons. On Kaggle, I plan to participate in beginner competitions to learn how to handle real-world data. Finally, I will use LinkedIn to share my progress as a Student Digital Ambassador and stay updated on the latest trends in the tech industry. By using these platforms regularly, I hope to build a strong professional identity before I graduate in 2029.

TASK-3

I chose HackerRank as my primary platform for coding. I successfully completed the beginner-level challenges in Python and earned my Bronze Badge.This practice helped me understand basic Python logic

Additionally, I used Google Form**s** to build a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. I created a Google Form with five specific questions to test how well my batchmates understand online safety, professional email etiquette and technical tools. I also linked this form to a Google Sheet so I can easily track and analyze the responses.

These tools will be very helpful for my academic success over the next four years. HackerRank will help me prepare for technical interviews and improve my problem-solving skills for my B.Tech courses. Meanwhile, Google Forms and Sheets are essential for my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, allowing me to collect data and share helpful resources with my batchmates effectively.

TASK-4

One common situation where poor digital communication causes problems is when a student sends an urgent email to a professor without a clear subject line. For example, a student might name their email Help or leave the subject blank. Because professors receive hundreds of emails, they might miss this message or think it is spam. This can lead to a serious problem: the student might miss a deadline, lose marks or fail an assignment simply because their request was never seen.

To prevent this, the student should have used a professional subject line, like Question about Assignment 1 - Student Name. They should also start with a polite greeting and explain their problem clearly. This helps the professor identify the issue quickly. Using a clear subject line and a polite greeting ensures that the message is taken seriously and answered properly.

TASK-5

While researching the topic of UPI Fraud and Phishing I was most surprised by how clever and real these scams look. I didn't realize that many scammers don't just hack into a system, they use Social Engineering to trick people into giving away their own Pins or passwords. This is when a criminal pretends to be someone you trust, like a bank officer or a helpful customer service agent. It was shocking to see how many students lose their hard earned money just by clicking a fake link or sharing a UPI pin. It surprised me to learn that even students who are good with technology can be fooled nowadays easily.

As a result of this research, the one habit I will personally change is how I handle Unknown Links. From now on, I will never click on a link in an SMS or email to make a payment. Instead, I will open the official app or website manually to check my account. I have also started using Two-Factor Authentication on all my main accounts to add an extra layer of safety.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, completing these five tasks has been a transformative experience that significantly improved my professional and technical confidence. Transitioning from a passive user to an active Digital
Ambassador has taught me the importance of maintaining a clean digital footprint and practicing safe online habits. Mastering tools like Google Forms for data collection and drafting professional emails has prepared me for future internship opportunities at companies like GreyOrange. I am now fully equipped with the essential skills to manage my digital identity, protect myself against cyber threats using the 1930 Helpline, and contribute meaningfully to the tech community.

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